

PowerPoint 2016

Getting Started with PowerPoint

Introduction

PowerPoint is a **presentation program** that allows you to create dynamic slide presentations. These presentations can include animation, narration, images, videos, and much more. In this lesson, you'll learn your way around the PowerPoint environment, including the **Ribbon**, **Quick Access Toolbar**, and **Backstage view**.

Watch the video below to learn more about getting started with PowerPoint.

PowerPoint: Getting Started



Getting to know PowerPoint

PowerPoint 2016 is similar to PowerPoint 2013 and PowerPoint 2010. If you have previously used these versions, PowerPoint 2016 should feel familiar. If you are new to PowerPoint or have more experience with older versions, you will need some time to become familiar with the **PowerPoint 2016 interface**.

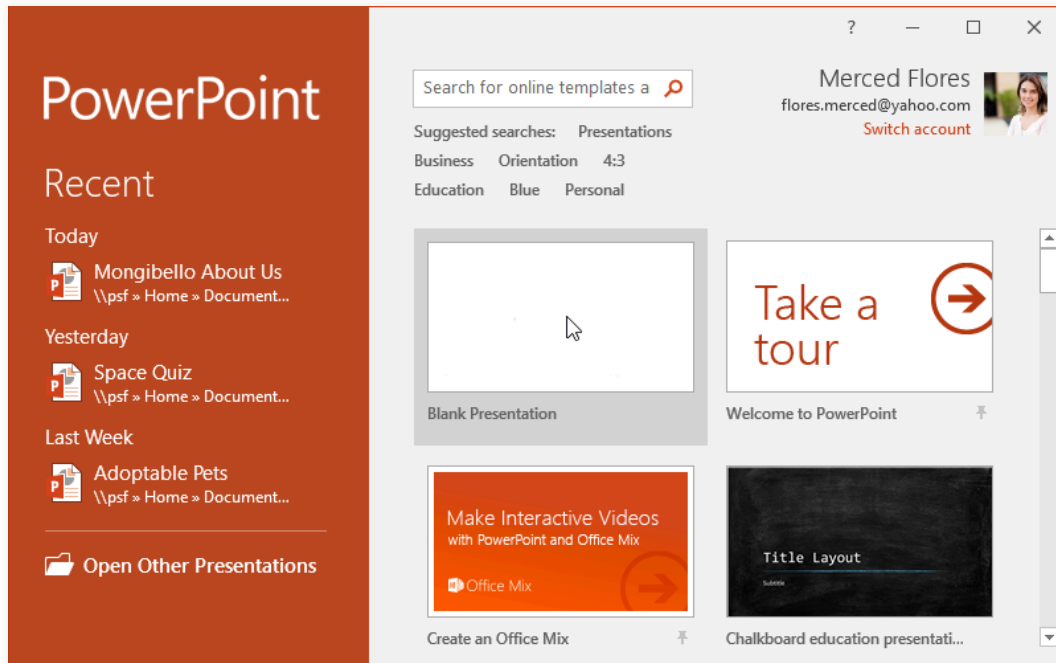


Welcome 🙌! How can we help you today?

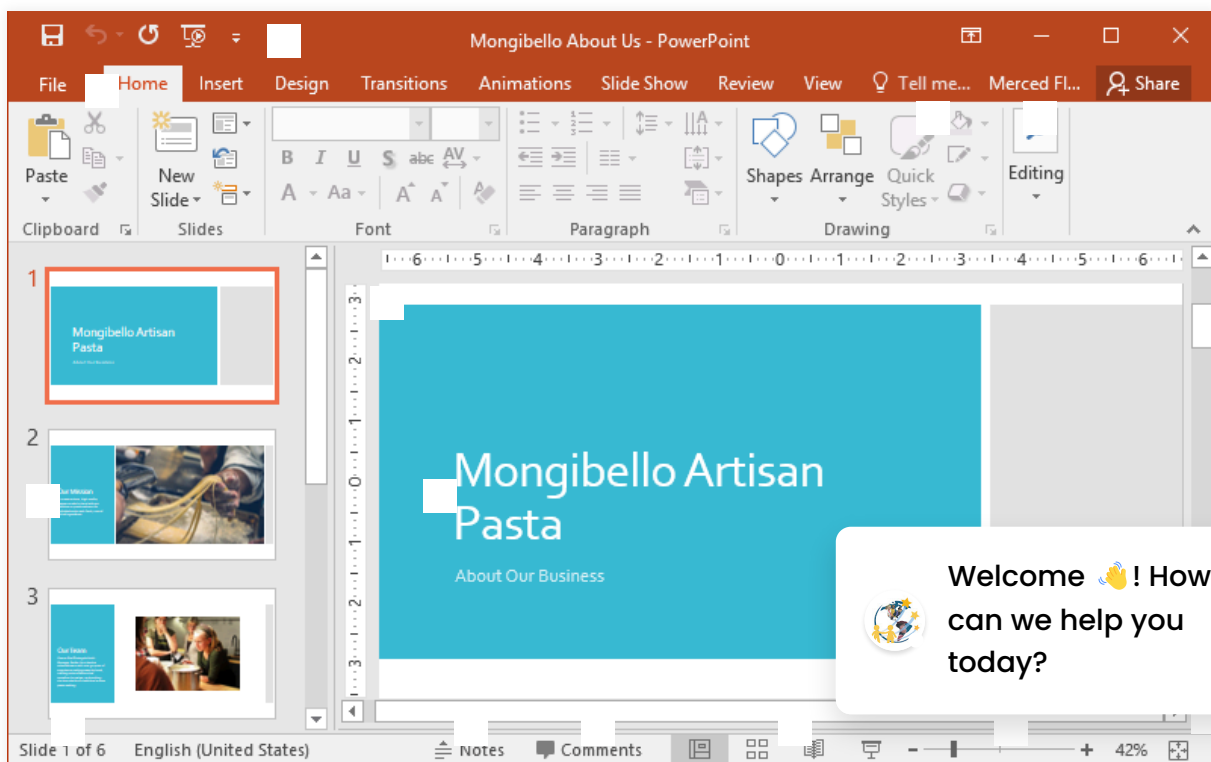


The PowerPoint interface

When you open PowerPoint for the first time, the **Start Screen** will appear. From here, you'll be able to create a **new presentation**, choose a **template**, and access your **recently edited presentations**. From the **Start Screen**, locate and select **Blank Presentation** to access the PowerPoint interface.



Click the buttons in the interactive below to become familiar with the PowerPoint interface.

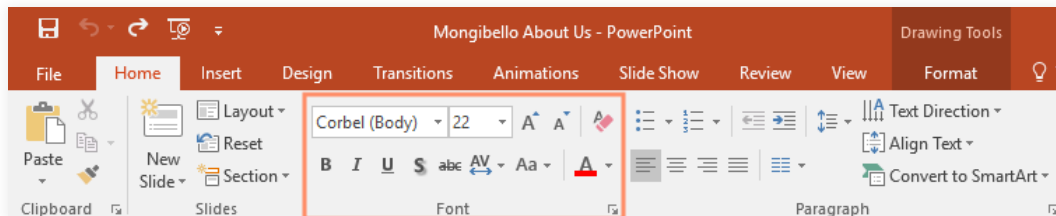


Working with the PowerPoint environment

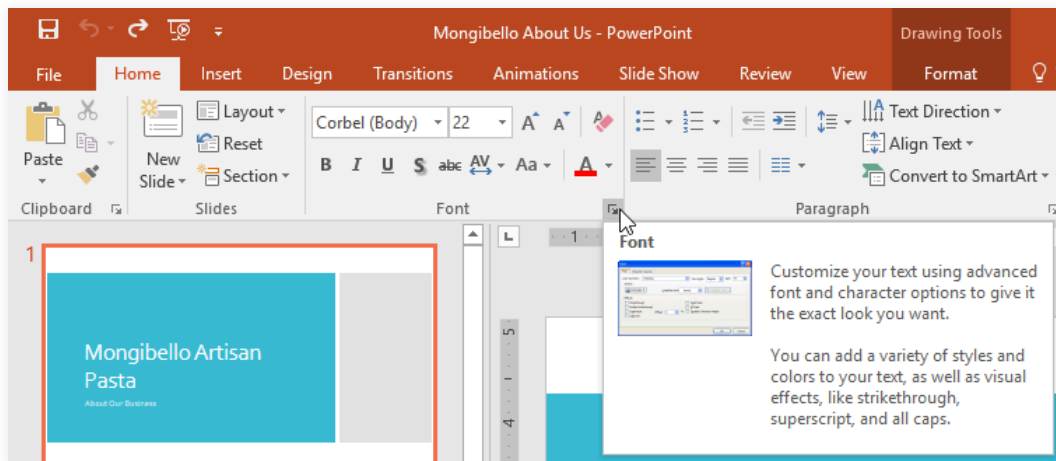
The **Ribbon** and **Quick Access Toolbar** are where you will find the commands to perform common tasks in PowerPoint. **Backstage view** gives you various options for saving, opening a file, printing, and sharing your document.

The Ribbon

PowerPoint uses a **tabbed Ribbon system** instead of traditional menus. **The Ribbon** contains **multiple tabs**, each with several **groups of commands**. For example, the Font group on the Home tab contains commands for formatting text in your document.



Some groups also have a **small arrow** in the bottom-right corner that you can click for even more options.

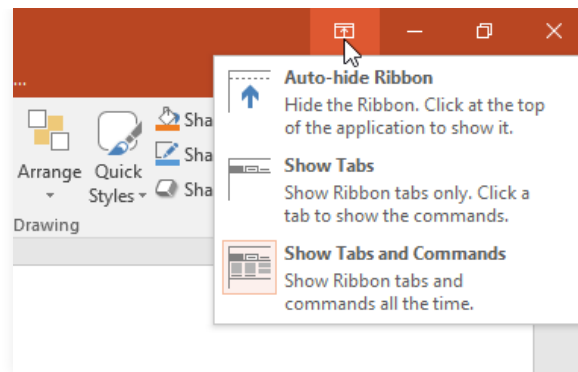


Showing and hiding the Ribbon

The Ribbon is designed to respond to your current task, but you can hide it if you find that it takes up too much screen space. Click the **Ribbon Display Options** arrow in the upper-right corner of the Ribbon to display the drop-down menu.



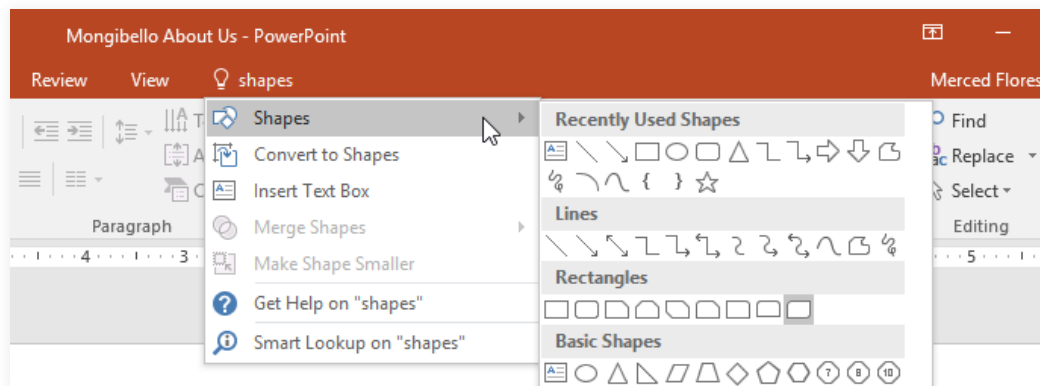
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- ▶ **Auto-hide Ribbon:** Auto-hide displays your workbook in full-screen mode and completely hides the Ribbon. To **show the Ribbon**, click the **Expand Ribbon** command at the top of screen.
- ▶ **Show Tabs:** This option hides all command groups when they're not in use, but **tabs** will remain visible. To **show the Ribbon**, simply click a tab.
- ▶ **Show Tabs and Commands:** This option maximizes the Ribbon. All of the tabs and commands will be visible. This option is selected by default when you open PowerPoint for the first time.

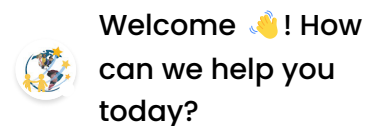
Using the Tell me feature

If you're having trouble finding command you want, the **Tell Me** feature can help. It works just like a regular search bar: Type what you're looking for, and a list of options will appear. You can then use the command directly from the menu without having to find it on the Ribbon.



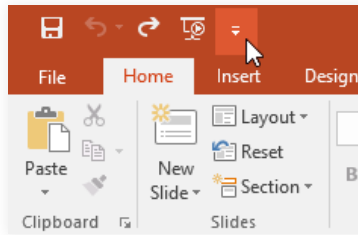
The Quick Access Toolbar

Located just above the Ribbon, the **Quick Access Toolbar** lets you access the **Save**, **Undo**, **Redo**, and **Start From Beginning** commands no matter which tab is selected. By default, it includes the **Save**, **Undo**, **Redo**, and **Start From Beginning** commands. You can add other commands depending on your preference.

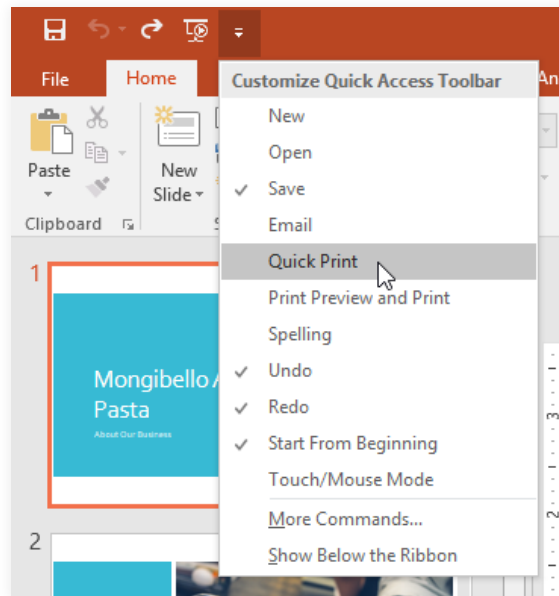


To add commands to the Quick Access Toolbar:

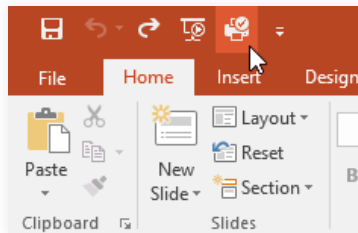
- 1 Click the **drop-down arrow** to the right of the **Quick Access Toolbar**.



- 2 Select the **command** you want to add from the drop-down menu. To choose from more commands, select **More Commands**.



- 3 The command will be added to the Quick Access Toolbar.

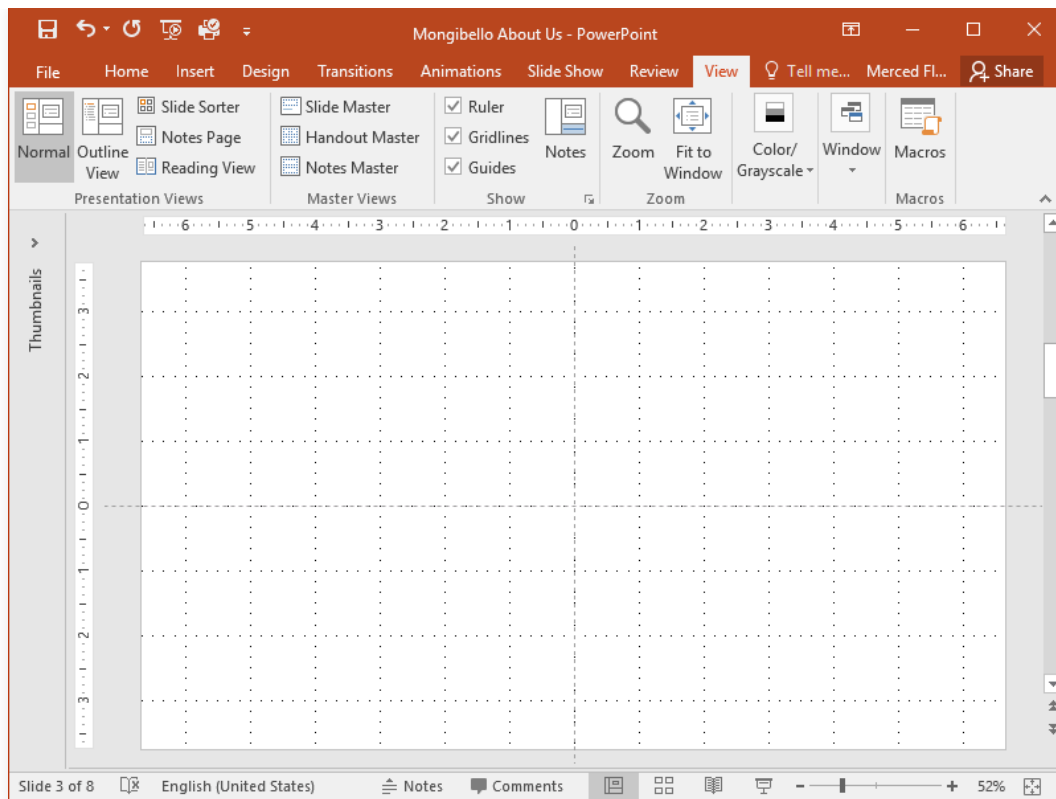


The Ruler, guides, and gridlines

PowerPoint includes several tools to help organize and arrange including the **Ruler**, **guides**, and **gridlines**. These tools make it on your slides. Simply click the **check boxes** in the **Show** group and hide these tools.



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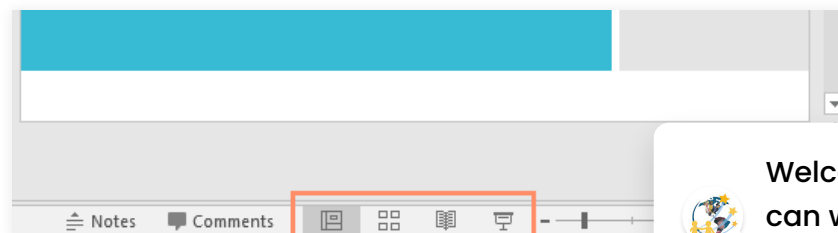


Zoom and other view options

PowerPoint has a variety of viewing options that change how your presentation is displayed. You can choose to view your presentation in **Normal** view, **Slide Sorter** view, **Reading** view, or **Slide Show** view. You can also **zoom in and out** to make your presentation easier to read.

Switching slide views

Switching between different slide views is easy. Just locate and select the desired **slide view command** in the bottom-right corner of the PowerPoint window.

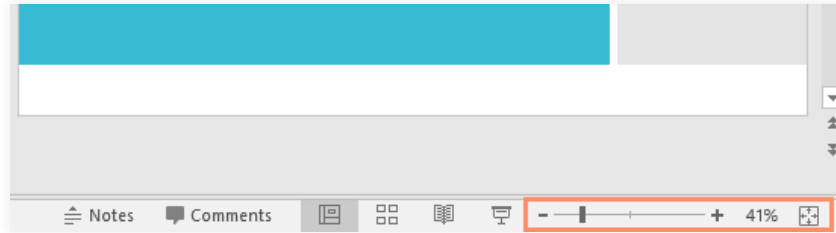


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To learn more about slide views, see our [Managing Slide](#)

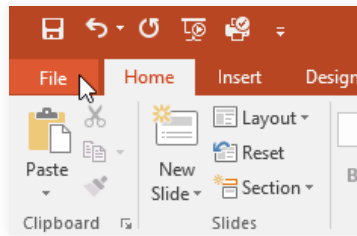
Zooming in and out

To zoom in or out, click and drag the **zoom control slider** in the bottom-right corner of the PowerPoint window. You can also select the **+** or **-** **commands** to zoom in or out by smaller increments. The number next to the slider displays the current **zoom percentage**, also called the **zoom level**.



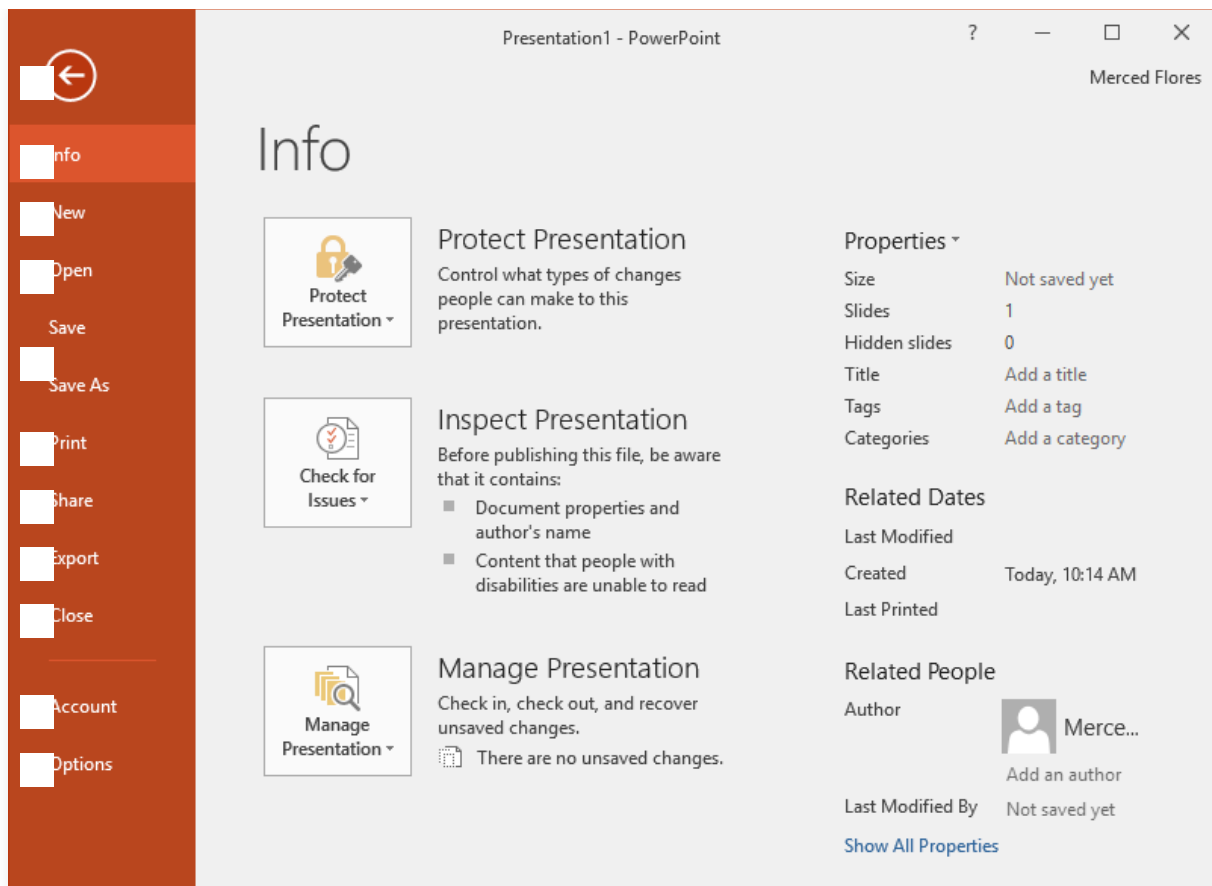
Backstage view

Backstage view gives you various options for saving, opening, printing, and sharing your presentations. To access Backstage view, click the **File** tab on the **Ribbon**.



Click the buttons in the interactive below to learn more about using Backstage view.

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You can review our lesson on [Understanding OneDrive](#) to learn more about using OneDrive.

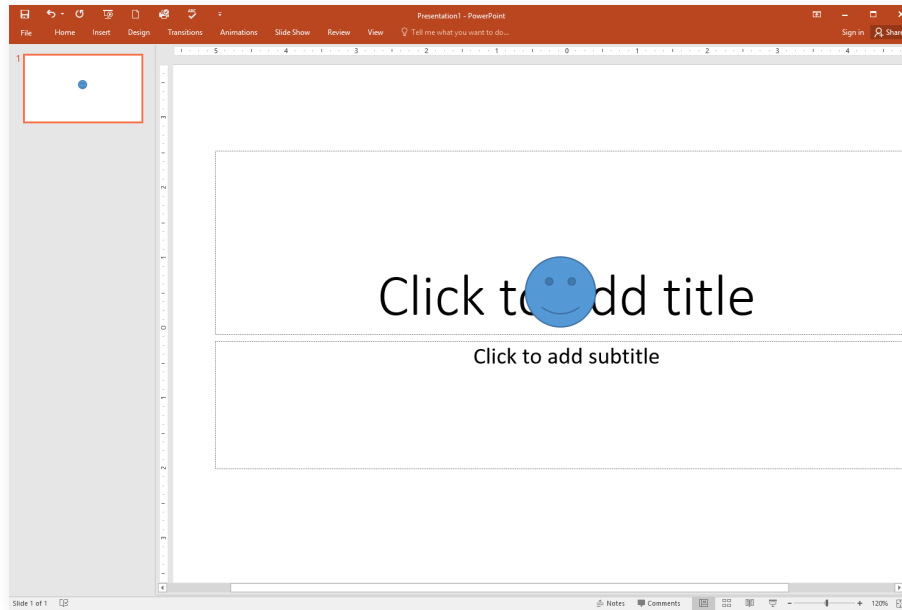
Challenge!

- 1 Open **PowerPoint 2016**, and create a **blank presentation**.
- 2 Change the **Ribbon Display Options** to **Show Tabs**.
- 3 Click the drop-down arrow next to the **Quick Access Toolbar** and add **New**, **Quick Print**, and **Spelling**.
- 4 In the **Tell me bar**, type **Shape** and press **Enter**.
- 5 Choose a shape from the menu, and double-click somewhere on the slide.
- 6 Show the **Ruler** if it is not already visible.



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- 7 **Zoom** the presentation to 120%.
- 8 When you're finished, your presentation should look something like this:



- 9 Change the **Ribbon Display Options** back to **Show Tabs and Commands**.



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